



General Assembly

February Session, 2026

Raised Bill No. 271

LCO No. 1650



Referred to Committee on LABOR AND PUBLIC EMPLOYEES

Introduced by:
(LAB)

AN ACT IMPLEMENTING THE RECOMMENDATIONS OF THE LABOR DEPARTMENT.

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Assembly convened:

1 Section 1. Subsection (c) of section 31-235 of the general statutes is
2 repealed and the following is substituted in lieu thereof (*Effective October*
3 *1, 2026*):

4 (c) (1) Notwithstanding the provisions of subsection (a) or (b) of this
5 section, an unemployed individual may limit such individual's
6 availability for work to part-time employment, provided the individual
7 (A) provides documentation from a [licensed physician, physician
8 assistant or advanced practice registered nurse] health care provider
9 that (i) the individual has a physical or mental impairment that is
10 chronic or is expected to be long-term or permanent in nature, and (ii)
11 the individual is unable to work full-time because of such impairment,
12 and (B) establishes, to the satisfaction of the administrator, that such
13 limitation does not effectively remove such individual from the labor
14 force. For purposes of this subdivision, "health care provider" has the
15 same meaning as provided in subparagraph (A) of subdivision (16) of

16 subsection (a) of section 31-236, as amended by this act.

17 (2) In determining whether the individual has satisfied the
18 requirements of subparagraph (B) of subdivision (1) of this subsection,
19 the administrator shall consider the individual's work history, efforts to
20 find work, the hours such individual is medically permitted to work and
21 the individual's availability during such hours for work that is suitable
22 in light of the individual's impairment.

23 Sec. 2. Subparagraph (A) of subdivision (16) of subsection (a) of
24 section 31-236 of the general statutes is repealed and the following is
25 substituted in lieu thereof (*Effective October 1, 2026*):

26 (16) (A) For purposes of subparagraph (A)(ii) of subdivision (2) of this
27 subsection, "illness or disability" means an illness or disability
28 diagnosed by a health care provider that necessitates care for the ill or
29 disabled person for a period of time longer than the employer is willing
30 to grant leave, paid or otherwise, and "health care provider" means (i) a
31 doctor of medicine or osteopathy who is authorized to practice medicine
32 or surgery by the state in which the doctor practices; (ii) a podiatrist,
33 dentist, psychologist, optometrist or chiropractor authorized to practice
34 by the state in which such person practices and performs within the
35 scope of the authorized practice; (iii) an advanced practice registered
36 nurse, nurse practitioner, nurse midwife, [or] clinical social worker or
37 physician's assistant authorized to practice by the state in which such
38 person practices and performs within the scope of the authorized
39 practice; (iv) Christian Science practitioners listed with the First Church
40 of Christ, Scientist in Boston, Massachusetts; (v) any medical
41 practitioner from whom an employer or a group health plan's benefits
42 manager will accept certification of the existence of a serious health
43 condition to substantiate a claim for benefits; (vi) a medical practitioner,
44 in a practice enumerated in clauses (i) to (v), inclusive, of this
45 subparagraph, who practices in a country other than the United States,
46 who is licensed to practice in accordance with the laws and regulations
47 of that country; or (vii) such other health care provider as the Labor

48 Commissioner approves, performing within the scope of the authorized
49 practice.

50 Sec. 3. Section 31-266c of the general statutes is repealed and the
51 following is substituted in lieu thereof (*Effective October 1, 2026*):

52 (a) The administrator, upon the advice of the Attorney General, may
53 abate any contributions or payments in lieu of contributions due under
54 this chapter which have been found by the administrator to be
55 uncollectible.

56 (b) The administrator or the administrator's duly authorized agent
57 may make or entertain an offer of compromise for any contributions or
58 payments in lieu of contributions due under this chapter if such offer is
59 based upon doubt as to the employer's liability for the amount in
60 controversy or doubt as to the collectibility of such amount. For
61 purposes of this section, doubt as to the employer's liability for the
62 amount in controversy exists if there is a genuine dispute as to the
63 existence or amount of the employer's liability under this chapter, and
64 doubt as to the collectibility of such amount exists if the employer's
65 assets and income are less than the full amount of the employer's debts,
66 obligations and liabilities under state or federal law.

67 Sec. 4. Section 53-303e of the general statutes is repealed and the
68 following is substituted in lieu thereof (*Effective October 1, 2026*):

69 (a) No employer shall compel any employee engaged in any
70 commercial occupation or in the work of any industrial process to work
71 more than six days in any calendar week. An employee's refusal to work
72 more than six days in any calendar week shall not constitute grounds
73 for [his] such employee's dismissal.

74 (b) Any employee, who believes that [his] such employee's discharge
75 was in violation of subsection (a) of this section may [appeal such
76 discharge to the State Board of Mediation and Arbitration] file a
77 complaint with the Labor Commissioner. If [said board] the

78 commissioner, or the commissioner's designee, finds that the employee
79 was discharged in violation of [said] subsection (a) of this section, [it]
80 the commissioner, or the commissioner's designee, may order whatever
81 remedy will make the employee whole, including, but not limited to,
82 reinstatement to [his] such employee's former position or a comparable
83 position. Any party aggrieved by a decision of the commissioner, or the
84 commissioner's designee, may appeal the decision to the Superior Court
85 in accordance with the provisions of chapter 54.

86 [(c) Any person who violates any provision of this section shall be
87 fined not more than two hundred dollars.]

88 Sec. 5. Section 14-10 of the 2026 supplement to the general statutes is
89 repealed and the following is substituted in lieu thereof (*Effective October*
90 *1, 2026*):

91 (a) For the purposes of this section:

92 (1) "Disclose" means to engage in any practice or conduct to make
93 available and make known, by any means of communication, personal
94 information or highly restricted personal information contained in a
95 motor vehicle record pertaining to an individual to any other individual,
96 organization or entity;

97 (2) "Motor vehicle record" means any record that pertains to an
98 operator's license, instruction or learner's permit, identity card,
99 registration, certificate of title or any other document issued by the
100 Department of Motor Vehicles. "Motor vehicle record" does not include
101 any record relating to vessels and certificates of title for vessels, as
102 provided in section 15-210;

103 (3) "Personal information" means information that identifies an
104 individual and includes an individual's photograph or computerized
105 image, Social Security number, operator's license number, name,
106 address other than the zip code, telephone number, electronic mail
107 address, or medical or disability information, but does not include

108 information on motor vehicle accidents or violations, or information
109 relative to the status of an operator's license, registration or insurance
110 coverage;

111 (4) "Highly restricted personal information" means an individual's
112 photograph or computerized image, Social Security number or medical
113 or disability information; [and]

114 (5) "Express consent" means an affirmative agreement given by the
115 individual who is the subject of personal information that specifically
116 grants permission to the department to release such information to the
117 requesting party. Such agreement shall (A) be in writing or such other
118 form as the commissioner may determine in regulations adopted in
119 accordance with the provisions of chapter 54, and (B) specify a
120 procedure for the individual to withdraw such consent, as provided in
121 regulations adopted in accordance with the provisions of chapter 54;
122 and

123 (6) "Labor organization" means any organization or association or
124 any agency or employee representation committee or plan that exists for
125 the purpose, in whole or part, of dealing with employers concerning
126 grievances, labor disputes, wages, rates of pay, hours of employment or
127 conditions of work, or any federation or council located in this state
128 representing any group of such labor organizations.

129 (b) A number shall be assigned to each motor vehicle registration and
130 operator's license and a record of all applications for motor vehicle
131 registrations and operators' licenses issued shall be kept by the
132 commissioner at the main office of the Department of Motor Vehicles.

133 (c) (1) All records of the Department of Motor Vehicles pertaining to
134 the application for registration, and the registration, of motor vehicles
135 of the current or previous three years shall be maintained by the
136 commissioner at the main office of the department. Any such records
137 over three years old may be destroyed at the discretion of the
138 commissioner. (2) Before disclosing personal information pertaining to

139 an applicant or registrant from such motor vehicle records or allowing
140 the inspection of any such record containing such personal information
141 in the course of any transaction conducted at such main office, the
142 commissioner shall ascertain whether such disclosure is authorized
143 under subsection (f) of this section, and require the person or entity
144 making the request to (A) complete an application that shall be on a
145 form prescribed by the commissioner, and (B) provide personal
146 identification satisfactory to the commissioner. An attorney-at-law
147 admitted to practice in this state may provide his or her juris number to
148 the commissioner in lieu of the requirements of subparagraph (B) of this
149 subdivision. The commissioner may disclose such personal information
150 or permit the inspection of such record containing such information
151 only if such disclosure is authorized under subsection (f) of this section.

152 (d) The commissioner may disclose personal information from a
153 motor vehicle record pertaining to an operator's license or a driving
154 history or permit the inspection or copying of any such record or history
155 containing such information in the course of any transaction conducted
156 at the main office of the department only if such disclosure is authorized
157 under subsection (f) of this section. Any such records over five years old
158 may be destroyed at the discretion of the commissioner.

159 (e) In the event (1) a federal court judge, federal court magistrate or
160 judge of the Superior Court, Appellate Court or Supreme Court of the
161 state, (2) a police officer, as defined in section 7-294a, or a member of the
162 Division of State Police within the Department of Emergency Services
163 and Public Protection, (3) an employee of the Department of Correction,
164 (4) an attorney-at-law who represents or has represented the state in a
165 criminal prosecution, (5) a member or employee of the Board of Pardons
166 and Paroles, (6) a judicial branch employee regularly engaged in court-
167 ordered enforcement or investigatory activities, (7) an inspector
168 employed by the Division of Criminal Justice, (8) a federal law
169 enforcement officer who works and resides in this state, (9) a state
170 referee under section 52-434, (10) a lake patrolman appointed pursuant
171 to subsection (a) of section 7-151b engaged in boating law enforcement,

172 or (11) a state marshal, submits a written request and furnishes such
173 individual's business address to the commissioner, such business
174 address only shall be disclosed or available for public inspection to the
175 extent authorized by this section.

176 (f) The commissioner may disclose personal information from a
177 motor vehicle record to:

178 (1) Any federal, state or local government agency in carrying out its
179 functions or to any individual or entity acting on behalf of any such
180 agency, or

181 (2) Any individual, organization or entity that signs and files with the
182 commissioner, under penalty of false statement as provided in section
183 53a-157b, a statement on a form approved by the commissioner,
184 together with such supporting documentation or information as the
185 commissioner may require, that such information will be used for any
186 of the following purposes:

187 (A) In connection with matters of motor vehicle or driver safety and
188 theft, motor vehicle emissions, motor vehicle product alterations, recalls
189 or advisories, performance monitoring of motor vehicles and dealers by
190 motor vehicle manufacturers, motor vehicle market research activities
191 including survey research, motor vehicle product and service
192 communications and removal of nonowner records from the original
193 owner records of motor vehicle manufacturers to implement the
194 provisions of the federal Automobile Information Disclosure Act, 15
195 USC 1231 et seq., the Clean Air Act, 42 USC 7401 et seq., and 49 USC
196 Chapters 301, 305 and 321 to 331, inclusive, as amended from time to
197 time, and any provision of the general statutes enacted to attain
198 compliance with said federal provisions;

199 (B) In the normal course of business by the requesting party, but only
200 to confirm the accuracy of personal information submitted by the
201 individual to the requesting party;

202 (C) In connection with any civil, criminal, administrative or arbitral
203 proceeding in any court or government agency or before any self-
204 regulatory body, including the service of process, an investigation in
205 anticipation of litigation by an attorney-at-law or any individual acting
206 on behalf of an attorney-at-law and the execution or enforcement of
207 judgments and orders, or pursuant to an order of any court provided
208 the requesting party is a party in interest to such proceeding;

209 (D) In connection with matters of motor vehicle or driver safety and
210 theft, motor vehicle emissions, motor vehicle product alterations, recalls
211 or advisories, performance monitoring of motor vehicles and motor
212 vehicle parts and dealers, producing statistical reports and removal of
213 nonowner records from the original owner records of motor vehicle
214 manufacturers, provided the personal information is not published,
215 disclosed or used to contact individuals except as permitted under
216 subparagraph (A) of this subdivision;

217 (E) By any insurer or insurance support organization or by a self-
218 insured entity or its agents, employees or contractors, in connection
219 with the investigation of claims arising under insurance policies,
220 antifraud activities, rating or underwriting;

221 (F) In providing any notice required by law to owners or lienholders
222 named in the certificate of title of towed, abandoned or impounded
223 motor vehicles;

224 (G) By an employer or its agent or insurer to obtain or verify
225 information relating to a holder of a passenger endorsement or
226 commercial driver's license required under 49 USC Chapter 313, and
227 sections 14-44 to 14-44m, inclusive;

228 (H) In connection with any lawful purpose of a labor organization,
229 [as defined in section 31-77,] provided (i) such organization has entered
230 into a contract with the commissioner, on such terms and conditions as
231 the commissioner may require, and (ii) the information will be used only
232 for the purposes specified in the contract other than campaign or

233 political purposes;

234 (I) For bulk distribution for surveys, marketing or solicitations
235 provided the commissioner has obtained the express consent of the
236 individual to whom such personal information pertains;

237 (J) For the purpose of preventing fraud by verifying the accuracy of
238 personal information contained in a motor vehicle record, including an
239 individual's photograph or computerized image, as submitted by an
240 individual to a legitimate business or an agent, employee or contractor
241 of a legitimate business, provided the individual has provided express
242 consent in accordance with subdivision (5) of subsection (a) of this
243 section;

244 (K) Inclusion of personal information about persons who have
245 indicated consent to become organ and tissue donors in a donor registry
246 established by a procurement organization, as defined in section 19a-
247 289a;

248 (L) By any private detective or private detective licensed in
249 accordance with the provisions of chapter 534, in connection with an
250 investigation involving matters concerning motor vehicles;

251 (M) By a state marshal, for use in the performance of duties under the
252 provisions of section 6-38a. Such information including, but not limited
253 to, (i) operator photos, and (ii) records produced by providing an
254 operator's license number, number plate or vehicle identification
255 number, may be requested and provided to a state marshal
256 electronically, or by such other means, within a reasonable time. Such
257 records may be transmitted to a state marshal by means of an existing
258 electronic system used by the Department of Motor Vehicles for the
259 transmission of records. The Commissioner of Motor Vehicles may
260 charge a state marshal a reasonable annual fee for access to such records
261 and the use of such electronic system.

262 (g) Any person receiving personal information or highly restricted

263 personal information from a motor vehicle record pursuant to
264 subsection (f) of this section shall be entitled to use such information for
265 any of the purposes set forth in said subsection for which such
266 information may be disclosed by the commissioner. No such person
267 may resell or redisclose the information for any purpose that is not set
268 forth in subsection (f) of this section, or reasonably related to any such
269 purpose.

270 (h) Notwithstanding any provision of this section, the disclosure of
271 personal information from a motor vehicle record pursuant to
272 subsection (f) of this section shall be subject to the provisions of section
273 14-50a concerning (1) the fees that shall be charged for copies of or
274 information pertaining to motor vehicle records and (2) the authority of
275 the commissioner to establish fees for information furnished on a
276 volume basis in accordance with such terms and conditions regarding
277 the use and distribution of such information as the commissioner may
278 prescribe.

279 (i) Notwithstanding any provision of this section that restricts or
280 prohibits the disclosure of personal information from a motor vehicle
281 record, the commissioner may disclose personal information contained
282 in any such record to any individual who is the subject of such personal
283 information or to any person who certifies under penalty of false
284 statement that such person has obtained the express consent of the
285 subject of such personal information.

286 (j) Notwithstanding any provision of this section that permits the
287 disclosure of personal information from a motor vehicle record, the
288 commissioner may disclose highly restricted personal information
289 contained in any such record only in accordance with the provisions of
290 18 USC 2721 et seq., as amended.

291 (k) Any person, including any officer, employee, agent or contractor
292 of the Department of Motor Vehicles, who sells, transfers or otherwise
293 discloses personal information or highly restricted personal information

294 obtained from the Department of Motor Vehicles for any purpose not
295 authorized by the provisions of this section shall be guilty of a class A
296 misdemeanor.

297 (l) The commissioner may adopt regulations in accordance with
298 chapter 54 to implement the provisions of this section.

299 Sec. 6. Sections 31-77 and 31-250a of the general statutes are repealed.
300 (*Effective October 1, 2026*)

This act shall take effect as follows and shall amend the following sections:		
Section 1	<i>October 1, 2026</i>	31-235(c)
Sec. 2	<i>October 1, 2026</i>	31-236(a)(16)(A)
Sec. 3	<i>October 1, 2026</i>	31-266c
Sec. 4	<i>October 1, 2026</i>	53-303e
Sec. 5	<i>October 1, 2026</i>	14-10
Sec. 6	<i>October 1, 2026</i>	Repealer section

This act shall take effect as follows and shall amend the following sections:		
Section 1	<i>October 1, 2026</i>	31-235(c)
Sec. 2	<i>October 1, 2026</i>	31-236(a)(16)(A)
Sec. 3	<i>October 1, 2026</i>	31-266c
Sec. 4	<i>October 1, 2026</i>	53-303e
Sec. 5	<i>October 1, 2026</i>	14-10
Sec. 6	<i>October 1, 2026</i>	Repealer section

Statement of Purpose:

To (1) create a uniform definition of "health care provider" in the unemployment statutes, (2) authorize the Labor Commissioner to make or entertain an offer of compromise for or abate any payments in lieu of contributions due by a reimbursing employer under the unemployment chapter, (3) move enforcement authority for section 53-303e of the general statutes to the Labor Department, (4) repeal the Employment Security Advisory Board, (5) remove the requirement that labor organizations annually file a report with the Labor Commissioner, and (6) make other technical and conforming changes.

[Proposed deletions are enclosed in brackets. Proposed additions are indicated by underline, except that when the entire text of a bill or resolution or a section of a bill or resolution is new, it is not underlined.]